$$f(x) = mx + b$$

- $f(x)$ = final value of dependent variable
- x = value of independent variable
- m = rate of change
- b = initial value of dependent variable

Initial wax: 17 oz
Remaining wax: 6 oz
Burn rate: 1 oz every 4 hours
Hours burned, h = ?

Burn rate = $-\frac{1 \text{ oz}}{4 \text{ hours}} = -\frac{1}{4}$ oz/hour

Remaining wax = (burn rate)(hours burned) + initial wax

$$6 = \left(-\frac{1}{4}\right)\text{h} + 17$$

$$6 - 17 = -\frac{1}{4}\text{h}$$

$$-11 = -\frac{1}{4}\text{h}$$

$$\text{h} = 44$$